

Developer build context, scope, route plan, stack, risks, delivery phases, and coordination plan for Ross, Adrian, Gil, Codex, and Claude Code.

Item	Detail
Domain	chitoryukaratedo.com
Owner / Client	Sensei Michael Noonan (ICKF)
Build Lead	Ross
SEO Coordination	Adrian
UI/UX Coordination	Gil
Build Goal	Official international Chito-Ryu website with approved dojo directory, teacher registry, leadership/history pages, Japanese/Romaji support, and secure admin approval flow.
Excluded From First Build	n8n, shop, payments, video library, paid member portal. These are future phases only after the official directory and approval system are stable.

Core decision: I will build the official website and directory first. I will not start with commerce, videos, or external automation. The first release must prove the official structure, the directory, admin access, approval control, SEO foundation, and clean public user experience.

1. Build Context

Mike asked for a new international Chito-Ryu website. The site needs to become the official online home for Chito-Ryu worldwide. It must show the leadership line, history, approved countries, approved dojos, senior teachers, news, rules, events, and contact paths in one controlled place.

This build is for a real international federation. I must treat the directory, names, ranks, access, and approvals carefully. The first build must be controlled, accurate, searchable, and easy to maintain.

The final build should let Mike approve the direction, let Adrian prepare the SEO structure, let Gil design the UI/UX, and let me proceed with the technical build using a clear route plan and phased procedure.

2. Competitor Research and Required Features

I checked other major karate organisations to understand what international karate sites normally include. The purpose is not to copy everything. The purpose is to identify the necessary parts Chito-Ryu should have from day one.

Organisation / Style	What They Have	What We Should Acquire
Shito-Ryu International Karate-Do Kai	Official branches, Soke lineage, syllabus, kata, affiliation, contact, and country branch listings.	Approved branch/country structure, Soke lineage, official dojo validation, and simple branch information.
JKA	Official home, branch search, accredited group/dojo information, qualifications, manuals, downloads, training and event content.	Official accreditation language, branch search, rules/resources, and controlled public information.
ISKF	Worldwide dojo directory with regional selection and location/contact information.	Clean worldwide dojo directory with country and city browsing.
IOGKF	International structure, executive leadership, large worldwide member network, events, committees, and official branding notes.	Clear international leadership structure, official organisation credibility, and global federation pages.
SKIF / other Shotokan bodies	International federation structure, news, events, resources, and shop in some regions.	Events, news, resources, and later commerce only after the core platform is stable.

Only required for first release: official home, leadership, history, dojo directory, teacher registry, news/events, rules/resources, contact, admin approval, Japanese/Romaji support, and SEO-ready routes.

Not required for first release: shop, payments, video library, public member accounts, external workflow automation, mobile app, and complex dashboards.

3. Final Scope for First Build

Included	Not Included Initially
Public website pages	Shop and payment processing
Approved country and dojo directory	Video library and paid training content
Teacher registry for approved senior teachers	n8n or external workflow automation
Japanese name + Romaji display	Mobile app
Admin access for controlled updates	Open public signup
Approval workflow before public changes	Self-publishing by country or dojo leaders
SEO sitemap, metadata, schema, redirects	Unapproved international branches or fake listings

4. Complete Tech Stack to Use

I will use a locked stack so the build does not stall from too many tool options. This stack is designed for a strong public website, searchable directory, secure admin access, and clean SEO foundation.

Layer	Tool / Service	Use
Frontend	Next.js App Router, React, TypeScript	Public pages, route structure, admin screens, server-rendered SEO pages.
Styling	Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui	Clean interface, reusable components, consistent forms and cards.
Hosting	Vercel	Production hosting, preview deployments, analytics, environment variables.
Content Editing	Sanity CMS	Leadership pages, history, news, rules, events, static content.
Operational Database	Supabase Postgres	Countries, dojos, teachers, roles, approvals, logs, rank evidence records.
Login / Access	Supabase Auth	Invite-only admin access and user identity tied to Supabase records.
Private Files	Supabase Storage	Private rank evidence and internal document uploads.
Email	Resend + React Email	Invite emails, approval notices, contact form confirmation, admin alerts.
Japanese/Romaji	Wanakana + manual approval	Kana-to-Romaji assistance, final human-approved spelling.
Validation	Zod	Safe form input and API payload checks.
Forms / Bot Protection	Cloudflare Turnstile	Reduce spam on contact and request forms.
Rate Limiting	Upstash Redis or Vercel firewall/rate limits	Protect login, invite, contact, and public search endpoints.
Monitoring	Sentry + Vercel Analytics	Error tracking, performance checks, production visibility.
SEO Tools	Google Search Console, GA4, sitemap generator	Indexing, traffic tracking, sitemap and route validation.
Testing	Playwright, Vitest, Testing Library	Route tests, form tests, admin workflow tests, regression checks.
Code Quality	ESLint, Prettier, TypeScript strict mode	Cleaner code, safer changes, consistent formatting.
Deployment Control	GitHub + Vercel Preview Deployments	Branch reviews, preview links for Mike, Adrian, and Gil.

Future-only tools: Stripe may be added for shop/payments later. Cloudflare Stream or Mux may be added for video later. They should not be part of the first release.

5. Architecture Summary

Area	Source of Truth	Rule
Public content	Sanity	Used for pages that Mike/Sohonbu can edit: history, leadership, news, rules, events.
Directory records	Supabase	Used for countries, dojos, teachers, ranks, approvals, and admin ownership.
User access	Supabase Auth + Supabase tables	Every admin has a clear role and country/dojo scope.
File evidence	Supabase Storage	Rank evidence and private documents are not public by default.
Live website	Next.js on Vercel	Public pages, SEO routes, admin pages, and secure API endpoints.

Important rule: the same record must not be edited in two places. Sanity is for page content. Supabase is for operational records. This prevents confusion and data mismatch.

6. Menu Structure

Top Menu	Route	Purpose
Home	/	Official Chito-Ryu international entry point.
About	/about	Who Chito-Ryu is, what the federation represents.

History	/history	Lineage, origin, and official background.
Leadership	/leadership	Soke line, current leadership, international authority.
Dojo Directory	/dojo-directory	Find approved dojos by country, city, instructor, and region.
Teachers	/teachers	Approved senior teacher listing.
News	/news	Official updates.
Events	/events	International seminars, schedules, and major dates.
Resources	/resources	Rules, forms, downloads, Soke Cup information, Bogu Kumite.
Sohonbu Experience	/sohonbu-experience	Information about training in Japan.
Contact	/contact	Official enquiry path.

7. Sitemap and Route Plan

Route Group	Routes
Public pages	/, /about, /history, /leadership, /contact, /privacy, /terms
Directory	/dojo-directory, /dojo-directory/[country], /dojo/[slug]
Teachers	/teachers, /teachers/[slug]
News	/news, /news/[slug]
Events	/events, /events/[slug]
Resources	/resources, /resources/soke-cup-rules, /resources/bogu-kumite, /resources/downloads
Sohonbu	/sohonbu-experience
Language routes	/en/*, /ja/*, /de/*, /fr/* where approved translations exist
Admin	/admin, /admin/dojos, /admin/teachers, /admin/approvals, /admin/news, /admin/events, /admin/settings
Auth	/login, /accept-invite, /reset-password
API	/api/contact, /api/revalidate, /api/v1/dojos, /api/v1/teachers, /api/admin/*

8. Data Model

Record	Required Fields	Control Rule
Country	name, slug, ISO code, region, public status	Created or approved by Sohonbu. Public only when approved.
Dojo	country, name, slug, address, city, contact email, head instructor, website, optional social links, status	Submitted by admin. Public only after approval.
Teacher	name_native, name_kana, name_romaji_final, rank, license number, dojo, country, photo, public status	Public only if rank and license are verified.
User	email, display name, role, country scope, dojo scope, MFA status	Access limited to assigned scope.
Approval	record type, record id, submitted by, submitted at, approved by, approved at, status, notes	Every public change must have an approval record.
Rank Evidence	teacher id, file, document type, submitted by, verifier, decision, decided at	Private by default. Not public.
Audit Log	user, action, record type, old value, new value, IP address, created at	Append-only. Cannot be edited.

9. Access Rules

Role	Can Do	Cannot Do
Sohonbu Admin	Approve countries, dojos, teachers, ranks, official content, and settings.	Cannot delete audit history.
Country Admin	Submit and update records for their own country.	Cannot publish directly. Cannot edit other countries.
Dojo Admin	Submit updates for their own dojo and teacher corrections.	Cannot approve ranks or publish public records.
Teacher	View own details and request corrections.	Cannot self-approve rank, license, or public listing.
Member / Public User	Browse public pages and directory.	Cannot edit directory or teacher records.

Default rule: no country or dojo admin self-publishes public records. Sohonbu approval keeps the international website accurate and controlled.

10. Japanese and Romaji Handling

Japanese names must stay correct. The site must store the original Japanese name and the approved Romaji spelling beside it so international members can read and search it.

Input	Stored Field	Public Display
Japanese characters	name_native	山田 太郎 / Yamada Taro
Kana reading	name_kana	やまだ たろう -> Yamada Taro
Suggested Romaji	name_romaji_auto	Auto-suggestion only
Final approved Romaji	name_romaji_final	Yamada Taro

Build rule: Japanese input is allowed. Kana reading is used to suggest Romaji. A person must still approve the final public spelling before it goes live. This prevents wrong names from being published.

For Mike-facing language, I can describe this as: Japanese name / English spelling. For the build, I will call it Japanese / Romaji and use the Hepburn style as the default spelling standard.

11. SEO Plan for Adrian

SEO Area	Action
Keyword map	Build keywords around Chito-Ryu, Chito-Ryu Karate-Do, international Chito-Ryu, Chito-Ryu dojos, Soke Cup, Bogu Kumite, Sohonbu training, and country-specific dojo searches.
Page titles	Every page gets a unique title. Country and dojo pages include country/city names.
Meta descriptions	Every public page gets a clean summary for Google.
Sitemap	Generate sitemap for pages, countries, dojos, teachers, news, and events.
Schema	Use organisation, local business/dojo, person/teacher, article/news, event, and breadcrumb structured data.
International SEO	Use hreflang only for approved translated pages. English is the fallback.
Redirects	Create redirect map if old domains or old pages need to point to the new site.
Content review	Adrian reviews SEO structure before build lock and again before launch.

12. UI/UX Plan for Gil

UI/UX Area	Action
Design direction	Clean traditional karate feel, strong hierarchy, international credibility, easy scanning.
Homepage	Clear purpose, leadership, dojo finder, history teaser, latest news/events, contact path.
Directory	Country filter, search box, map/list option if practical, dojo cards, official approval indicator.
Teachers	Simple teacher cards with name, rank, dojo, country, photo if approved.
Admin screens	Plain forms, clear status labels, pending/approved/rejected states.
Mobile	Directory and contact pages must work well on phone first.
Accessibility	Readable contrast, clear headings, keyboard navigation, form labels, no text hidden inside images.
Review flow	Gil delivers wireframes/design comps before full component build.

13. Phased Build Timeline

Phase	Duration	Main Output
Phase 0 - Approval and Access	2-3 days	Mike approves scope. Domain access, DNS, brand assets, content sources, current dojo/rank source, and admin contacts confirmed.
Phase 1 - Project Foundation	1 week	GitHub repo, Next.js app, Vercel, Sanity, Supabase, base layout, environment setup, QA scripts.
Phase 2 - Public Website Structure	1-2 weeks	Home, About, History, Leadership, Resources, Contact, privacy pages, CMS-driven content model.
Phase 3 - Directory and Data Model	2 weeks	Country, dojo, teacher, approval, audit, rank evidence models; import template; public directory routes.
Phase 4 - Admin and Access Control	2 weeks	Invite-only login, admin dashboard, roles, approval flow, scoped edit access, audit logs.
Phase 5 - Japanese/Romaji and Search	1 week	Japanese input, Romaji fields, search, filters, sitemap-ready pages.
Phase 6 - SEO and UI/UX Lock	1 week	Adrian SEO pass, Gil UI/UX pass, route/meta/schema review, content layout fixes.
Phase 7 - QA and Security	1 week	Testing, rate limiting, bot protection, accessibility, performance, backup restore test, admin training guide.
Phase 8 - Launch	2-3 days	DNS cutover, production deploy, sitemap submission, post-launch monitoring, issue fix window.

Estimated first release: 9 to 11 weeks after access, content, and approval rules are confirmed. Shop and video are separate later phases.

14. Launch Gates

Gate	Required Before Launch
Content	Leadership, history, contact, rules, sample countries/dojos/teachers approved.
Access	Admin roles tested. Country and dojo admins cannot publish directly.
Data	Duplicate dojo/teacher records removed. Evidence files private.
Japanese/Romaji	Japanese input and final public display tested.
SEO	Sitemap, metadata, schema, canonical URLs, and Search Console ready.
Security	Rate limiting, bot protection, access checks, audit log, and private file rules verified.
Performance	Core pages tested on mobile and desktop.
Training	Mike/Sohonbu admin guide prepared.

15. Developer Work Rules

Rule	Instruction
No external automation in first release	All basic notices, approvals, and logs stay inside the website build.
No public self-publishing	All public directory and rank changes require approval.
No shop or payments in first release	Payment model is planned later after seller rules are confirmed.
No video library in first release	Video access rules must be confirmed before any build.
No fake completeness	Only publish approved countries, approved dojos, and verified teachers.
No duplicate sources of truth	Sanity for public content. Supabase for directory/admin records.
No hidden sensitive data exposure	Rank evidence and internal uploads remain private.
No launch without restore test	Backups must be tested, not only configured.

16. Immediate Next Actions

Owner	Action
Ross	Prepare repo, environment checklist, import templates, data model, and build procedure.
Mike	Approve final scope, domain access, official content source, country/dojo source, and rank verifier.
Adrian	Review SEO route structure, keywords, metadata pattern, sitemap and schema plan.
Gil	Prepare UI/UX direction for homepage, directory, teacher page, and admin forms.
Sohonbu / Mike Delegate	Prepare official country, dojo, teacher, and rank source file.

17. Source Notes

Competitor reference points checked: Shito-Ryu International Karate-Do Kai branch structure, JKA official branch search and resources, ISKF worldwide dojo directory, IOGKF international structure, and related international karate organisation examples. Technical references checked: Next.js App Router, Sanity revalidation webhooks, Supabase Row Level Security, and Stripe Connect account documentation for future payment planning.